

SENECA POLICE DEPARTMENT	7-01 STANDARD OPERATING PROCEEDURES
SUBJECT: ALPR'S/FLOCK CAMERAS	REVIEW DATE: ANNUALLY-AUGUST
EFFECTIVE DATE: 8/04/2025	ACTION DATE:
AMENDS/SUPERSEDES:	AMEND DATE:
	APPROVED: _____ Chief of Police

I. POLICY

Officers/personnel may only use ALPR's/FLOCK cameras and data for legitimate law enforcement purposes. ALPR's/FLOCK cameras and data may only be accessed by authorized personnel.

II. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) technology, also known as License Plate Recognition, provides automated detection of license plates. FLOCK Safety is a vendor of ALPR cameras. The ALPR/FLOCK camera is used by the Seneca Police Department to convert data associated with vehicle license plates and use it for official law enforcement purposes, including identifying stolen or wanted vehicles, stolen license plates, missing persons, child abduction/AMBER alerts, and to aid in other lawful enforcement or emergency purposes to include criminal and/or administrative investigations. The ALPR/FLOCK cameras may also be used to gather information related to active warrants, homeland security, electronic surveillance, suspect interdiction, investigative purposes, and stolen property recovery.

III. DEFINITIONS

ALPR-Automated license plate readers (ALPRs) are high-speed, computer-controlled camera systems that are typically mounted on street poles, streetlights, or mobile trailers. ALPRs automatically capture all license plate numbers that come into view, along with the location date and time. The data, which includes photographs of the vehicle and sometimes its driver and passengers, is then uploaded to a central server.

FLOCK - An infrastructure-free license plate reader camera that utilizes Vehicle Fingerprint technology to capture vehicular attributes from vendor Flock Safety.

IV. ALPR/FLOCK CAMERA OPERATION/PROCEDURES

Use of ALPR/FLOCK cameras is restricted to the purposes outlined below. Department personnel shall not use, or allow others to use, the equipment or database records for any unauthorized purpose.

- (1) An ALPR/FLOCK camera shall only be used for official and legitimate law enforcement business.
- (2) An ALPR/FLOCK camera may be used in conjunction with any patrol operation or official Department investigation. Reasonable suspicion or probable cause is not necessary before using ALPR.
- (3) No member of this Department shall operate ALPR/FLOCK camera equipment or access ALPR/FLOCK data without first completing Department approved training.
- (4) No ALPR/FLOCK camera operator may access MULES data unless otherwise authorized to do so.
- (5) If practicable, the officer should verify an ALPR/FLOCK camera response through MULES before taking enforcement action that is based solely upon an ALPR alert.

V. DEPLOYMENT OF ALPR/FLOCK CAMERAS

- (1) Flock Safety is responsible for installation and maintenance of fixed cameras at an agreed upon location within the city limits.
- (2) User access is granted to personnel who have a job-related need for ALPR/FLOCK data.
- (3) Data within the Flock Safety system is for official use only.
- (4) Users shall exhibit the same confidentiality and security practices as is used with NCIC and MULES information.
- (5) Misuse of the system shall result in disciplinary action.

VI. DATA SHARING AND DISSEMINATION

- (1) Data collected is property of Flock Safety and only stored for a maximum of 30 days. Data collected should be considered for official use only and can be shared for Legitimate law enforcement purposes.
- (2) Sharing of data will be at the discretion of the Chief of Police or his designee and shall only be for legitimate law enforcement purposes.

(3) ALPR/FLOCK camera data can be shared among law enforcement agencies for legitimate law enforcement purposes in accordance with department policies

(4) ALPR/FLOCK camera data should be considered for official use and is exempt from mandatory release to the public under RSMO 610.100, subsection 3, known as the “Missouri Sunshine Law.”

VII. DATA RETENTION

(1) All license and vehicle data recorded by Flock Safety is retained for maximum of 30 Days.

VIII. ADMINISTRATION

(1) A yearly audit of ALPR/FLOCK system use shall be conducted by the system administrators.

IX. DATA SECURITY AND ACCESS

ALPR/FLOCK Camera devices/databases will be utilized /accessed for law enforcement purposes only and only by authorized users.

(1) Personnel will not release any information obtained by the ALPR/FLOCK devices to non-law enforcement personnel unless required by law.

(2) Persons approved to access ALPR/FLOCK device data under these guidelines are permitted to access the data for legitimate law enforcement purposes only, such as when the data relates to legitimate law enforcement purposes, criminal investigations, or Department related civil or administrative action.

(3) Sworn law enforcement officers from outside law enforcement agencies may be given access to the ALPR/FLOCK camera devices and databases but must adhere to Seneca Police Department policies and procedures found herein.